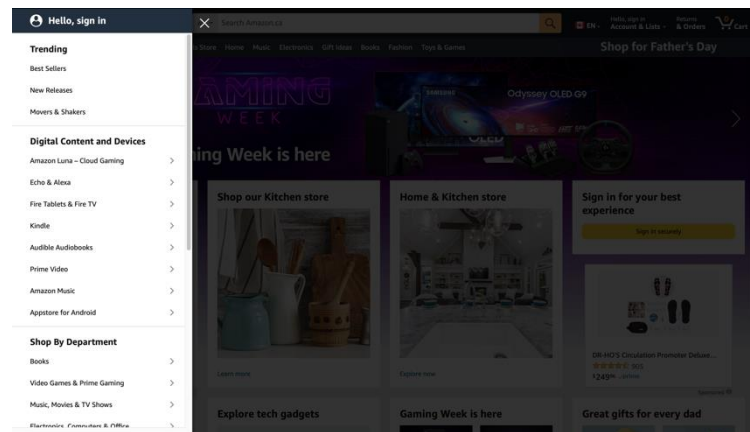


Website Evaluation (<https://www.amazon.ca>)

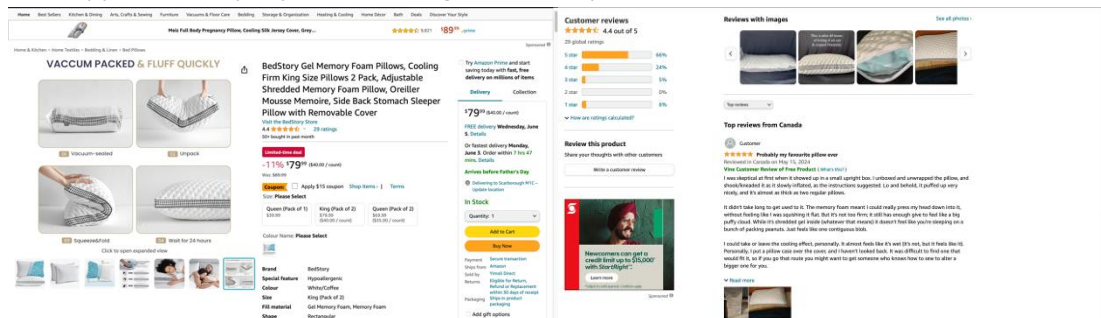
Purpose and Feature:

`Amazon.ca` is a comprehensive online platform which provides a various set of products and services to consumers worldwide. It offers many items, including books, apparel, household items, electronics, and more, to meet the needs of different consumers. (Wikipedia contributors, 2024)



1.1 The `home` interface of current Amazon.com

The main features of Amazon are comments of customers, global item search, items navigation, personalized recommendations and the Prime upgrading. Moreover, Amazon Prime also offers many benefits of senior servy of delivery, partial free of video, Amazon music and free DashPass with Prime. To creat a diverse shopping environment and expand the market, Amazon also supports third-party sellers through its marketplace.



1.2 Recommendations and some users' comments

Comparison with 5 years back:

When I directly compare the current website with one 5 years back, there are approximately 4 aspects: layout and navigation, visual design, search and recommendation and promotional content.

For layout, the navigation of old version is primarily text-based with categories lists and set in the left and top of the website. It looks cluttered and lacks visual hierarchy. However, the current navigation is more visually structured, such as drop-down menus and a sidebar that integrates both text and icons. The old visual design is full of text and links rather than images or pictures, which is less modern and visually appealing than the current one. Besides, comparing with the old version, the current version enhances search functionality with predictive text and

Today's Deals

Shop Daily Essentials for dad

Home & Kitchen store

Dad-approved Coupons

Gaming Week is here

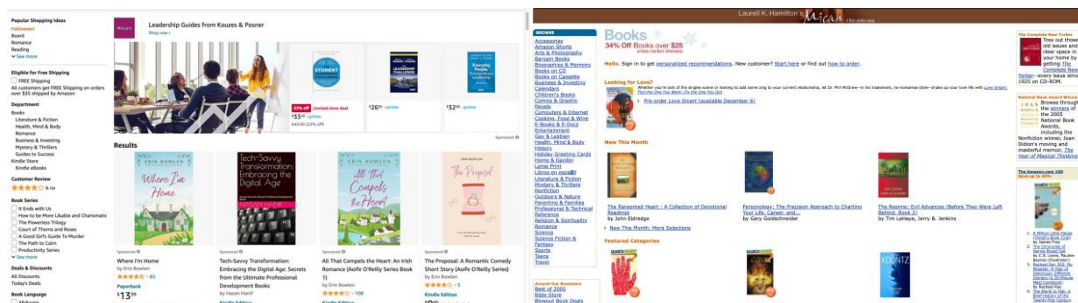
Hear Stephen Fry read Harry Potter

Sign in for your best experience

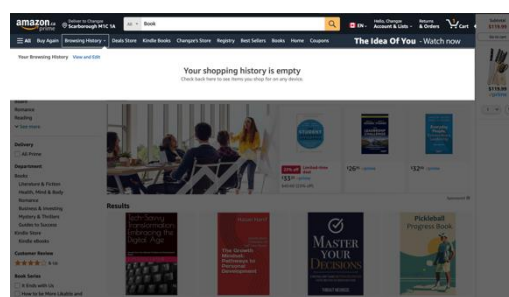
Get Dad Handpicked Electronics

However, let's elaborate on each rule.

Regarding the first rule, "Strive for consistency," the old Amazon website had an inconsistent design, varying font sizes and styles and a cluttered interface which made it difficult for users to navigate. The current website solves this problem by implementing a uniform color scheme, consistent typography, and structured layout. The position and style of navigation elements, such as menus and buttons, are consistent, which helps users predict where and how these elements will behave across different pages. This consistency reduces cognitive load, enhances the overall user experience, and makes the interface more intuitive and easier to use.

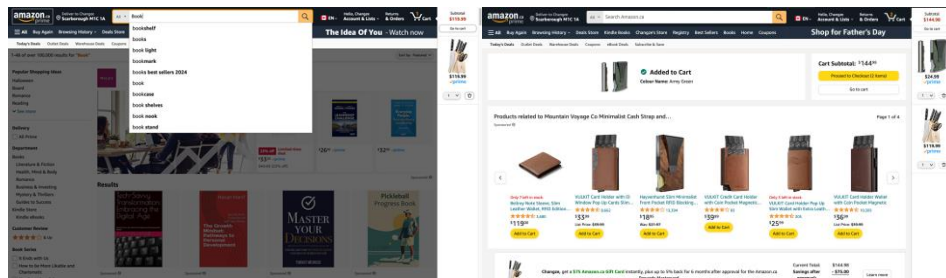


In terms of enabling frequent users to use shortcuts, Amazon.com provided limited shortcuts in previous versions, focusing primarily on broad accessibility, resulting in a mediocre user experience. The current version improves usability for frequent users by introducing features such as predictive search, quick access to frequently visited sections, and personalized recommendations based on browsing history. These improvements enable advanced users to navigate the site more efficiently and reduce the time it takes to find a specific product or section. The streamlined experience of shortcuts and quick access options caters to the needs of new and returning users, improving overall satisfaction and engagement.



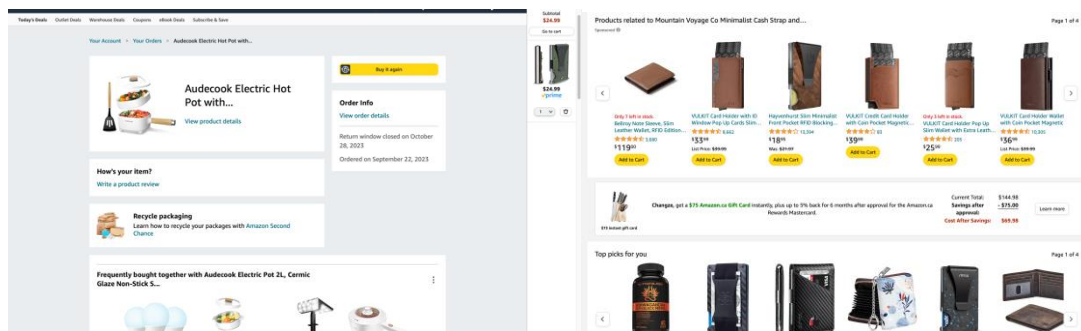
2.3 The shop history helps access history next time

In order to implement the third rule, providing feedback on information, Amazon improves feedback by providing real-time updates and clearer notifications. For example, users can receive immediate feedback when adding an item to their shopping cart, completing a purchase, or searching for a product. Progress metrics and detailed confirmation messages help users understand the status of their operations, reducing uncertainty and increasing confidence. This information feedback ensures that users are fully informed at every step of the interaction, resulting in a smoother, more reassuring experience.



2.4 Improving feedback by providing real-time updates and clearer notifications

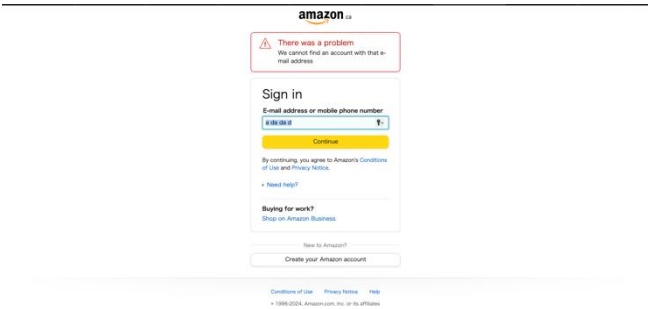
According to the “Design Dialogs to Yield Closure” Rule, the current version enhances this by designing dialogs that not only confirm task completion, but also suggest next steps or related actions. For example, after completing a purchase, users might see recommendations for related products or a prompt to track their order. These enhancements provide a sense of closure and continuity, ensuring that users feel their actions are complete and understood. This design approach helps users smoothly transition to the next task, which improves overall satisfaction. However, the old version of Amazon.com provided simple confirmation messages when completing a task, such as making a purchase or submitting a form, which provided basic closure.



2.5 Recommendations for related products or a prompt to track their order

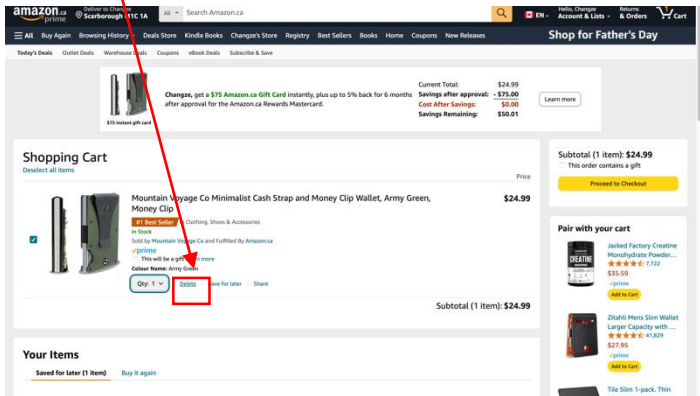
In older versions, error messages were basic and focused primarily on notifying users of a problem without providing much guidance on how to resolve it. Amazon.com's current version improves on this by providing a more user-friendly approach to error handling. Error messages now come with clear instructions on how to correct the error, such as providing suggestions for valid input formats or highlighting specific fields that require attention. Visual cues, such as a red border around an incorrect input, help users quickly identify and correct errors. This approach

reduces frustration and enhances the overall user experience by making error resolution simple.



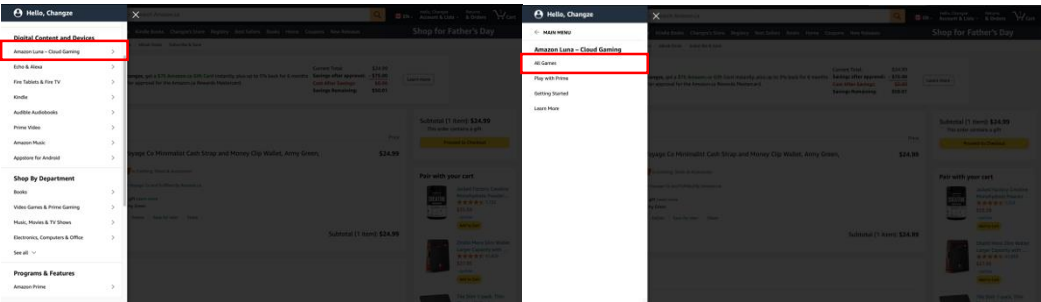
2.6 red border around an incorrect input

To adjust to the rule of Permit Easy Reversal of Actions, the current version significantly improves this issue by providing more intuitive options for undo operations. For example, users can easily remove items from their shopping cart, edit an order before completing it, or revert changes to their profile settings. These undo options enable users to try and make changes without fear of making irreversible mistakes, increasing their sense of control and confidence when using the platform.



2.7 users can easily remove items from their shopping cart

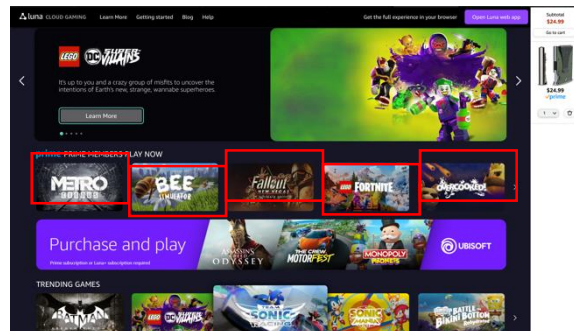
The old version of Amazon.com had a cluttered interface and inconsistent navigation, which could make users feel out of control of their browsing and purchasing experience. The current version addresses this by providing a simplified design and intuitive navigation that empowers users. Clear menus, well-organized categories, and a logical layout help users find what they need quickly and efficiently. This design approach supports an internal locus of control, ensuring that users feel competent and confident when navigating the site and making decisions, resulting in a more satisfying and empowered user experience.



2.8 cluttered interface and inconsistent navigation

The old version of Amazon.com often presented dense information with little visual

hierarchy, leading to potential cognitive overload for users. In order to reduce Short-Term memory load, the current version features a more concise layout with clear categories and visual aids to minimize short-term memory load. Information is presented in easy-to-understand blocks, with important elements such as product titles, prices, and images highlighted. Reducing the amount of information on the screen helps users focus on their tasks without being overwhelmed by irrelevant details. By simplifying the information presentation, the current design improves usability and reduces the cognitive effort required to navigate the site.



2.9 Easy-to-understand blocks

Two Recommendations:

1. Permit Easy Reversal of Actions

Problem: Although the current Amazon.com design allows for undoing certain actions, such as removing an item from a shopping cart, it can be cumbersome for users to undo certain actions, such as accidental purchases or modifications to account settings. (see picture 2.7)

Solution: Introduce an "Undo" feature prominently on the interface, enabling users to easily revert recent actions, such as removing an item from the cart, cancelling an order within a short period, or undoing changes to their account settings.

Explanation: The Undo feature displays a temporary popup after the user performs an action, giving the user the option to undo that action. This popup can include a timer indicating how long the Undo option will be in effect.

Iterate your ideas: Making the "Undo" option prominent and easy to access right after an action. Making the "Undo" option prominent and easy to access right after an action. Providing a clear indication of how long users must undo the action.



2. Enable Frequent Users to Use Shortcuts

Problem: Although the current Amazon.com design includes some shortcuts and personalization features, there is still room for improvement in making common actions

more accessible.

Solution: Introducing a customizable toolbar that allows users to add shortcuts to the most common actions, such as viewing orders, accessing wish lists, checking out, and viewing recommended products.

Explanation: The toolbar will be a persistent element on the screen providing quick access to commonly used actions. Users can customize this toolbar by dragging and dropping icons from the settings menu. This will reduce the time spent navigating menus and enhance the user experience for frequent shoppers.

Iterate your ideas: Allows users to tailor their interface to their specific needs, enhancing efficiency. Makes customization intuitive and easy for users. Ensures quick access without needing to navigate through the entire site.

